How to Make Money on TikTok in 2026: 10 Proven Monetization Methods

2026 Guide · 10 Monetization Methods | Updated October 28, 2026

You can turn your TikTok audience into income through sponsorships, affiliate promotions, TikTok's creator monetization programs, and direct sales.TikTok has become much more than a platform for short entertainment videos.

If In 2026, creators can use TikTok to build an audience, promote products, attract customers, work with brands, and explore different creator monetization options.

If you are searching for **how to make money on TikTok**, the first thing to understand is that there is no single income source that works for everyone. Some creators earn directly through TikTok features, while others use their audience to generate income through affiliate marketing, sponsorships, services, digital products, or businesses.

The good news is that you can start building a monetization strategy even if your account is relatively small. What matters is having a clear topic, creating content people want to watch, and connecting your audience with an appropriate way to generate revenue.

Here are 10 proven monetization methods to consider in 2026.

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Can You Make Money on TikTok in 2026?

Yes, TikTok can be used to generate income in several different ways.

Your options may include:

* TikTok's creator monetization programs
* Brand sponsorships
* Affiliate marketing
* TikTok Shop or shopping-related opportunities where available
* LIVE features
* Selling products
* Selling digital products
* Offering services
* User-generated content
* Sending traffic to an external business or website

However, not every feature is available in every country, and eligibility requirements can change.

That means your first step should be determining which monetization features are currently available to your account and location.

1. Earn Through the Creator Rewards Program

One of the most direct methods for eligible creators is TikTok's **Creator Rewards Program**.

The program is designed to reward eligible creators for qualifying original content. Instead of relying exclusively on sponsorships or selling products, creators can potentially earn through TikTok's own creator monetization system.

If you are considering this method, pay attention to the current eligibility rules.

Requirements can include factors related to:

* Age
* Account status
* Followers
* Video views
* Originality
* Account activity
* Country or region

Because these conditions can change, always check the current requirements displayed by TikTok rather than relying on old Creator Fund information.

What Is the TikTok Creator Fund?

The **TikTok Creator Fund** is an older monetization term that still appears in many searches.

TikTok has moved toward newer creator monetization systems, including the Creator Rewards Program in eligible markets. Therefore, someone researching creator payments in 2026 should distinguish between the older Creator Fund and the current programs available to their account.

2. Make Money Through Brand Sponsorships

Brand deals are one of the most recognizable ways creators earn money on TikTok.

A company may pay a creator to produce content that introduces its product or service to a relevant audience.

A campaign might involve:

* A sponsored video
* Product demonstration
* Tutorial
* Review
* Brand mention
* UGC-style advertisement
* Series of videos

You do not necessarily need millions of followers.

A creator with a focused audience can be useful to a company if that audience closely matches the brand's target customers.

For example, a creator focused on affordable technology could attract brands selling phone accessories, software, gadgets, or related products.

How to Attract Brand Deals

Start by making your account easy for brands to understand.

Your profile should make it clear:

* What your niche is
* What type of audience you attract

* What kind of content you create
* How a company can contact you

You can also create sample product videos to demonstrate your ability to produce sponsored-style content.

3. Use Affiliate Marketing

Affiliate marketing lets you earn a commission when someone purchases a product or completes another qualifying action through your referral.

This can be particularly useful for creators who do not want to create their own products.

For example, a creator could make videos about:

* Software
* Beauty products
* Fitness equipment
* Home products
* Gaming accessories
* Books
* Technology
* Fashion
* Educational resources

A good affiliate video should provide information rather than simply saying that viewers should buy something.

You might compare products, demonstrate how something works, explain its benefits, or

show how you use it.

The more useful the video is, the more natural the affiliate recommendation can become.

4. Sell Your Own Products

If you have your own product, TikTok can become a powerful discovery and marketing channel.

Products can include physical goods as well as specialized products created for a particular audience.

Examples include:

* Clothing
* Accessories
* Art
* Handmade products
* Beauty products
* Fitness products
* Hobby products
* Customized merchandise

TikTok videos can demonstrate how the product works, answer common questions, show different use cases, or introduce new products.

Depending on your location and account, TikTok's shopping features may also provide ways to connect content with products.

The exact shopping features available can vary by market.

5. Sell Digital Products

Digital products can be attractive because they do not require physical inventory.

If you have knowledge or a skill that people find useful, you can turn that knowledge into a digital resource.

Possible examples include:

* Ebooks
* Templates
* Guides
* Checklists
* Study materials
* Design resources
* Spreadsheet templates
* Planning documents
* Educational downloads
* Digital toolkits

For example, a creator focused on productivity could create a downloadable planning template.

A creator focused on job hunting could create a resume template or interview preparation guide.

The TikTok content provides useful information while the digital product offers a more complete resource for people who want additional help.

6. Offer Freelance or Professional Services

You can also **make money from TikTok** without selling a physical product.

If you have a professional skill, TikTok can be used to demonstrate that skill and attract potential customers.

Some examples include:

* SEO
* Writing
* Graphic design
* Video editing
* Web development
* Photography
* Social media management
* Coaching
* Tutoring
* Consulting
* Translation

Suppose you are a video editor.

Instead of simply posting "I am a video editor," you could create short videos showing editing techniques, before-and-after examples, common mistakes, or useful tips.

Potential clients who find the content helpful can then visit your profile and contact you.

7. Make Money Through TikTok LIVE

LIVE content creates a different relationship between creators and their audience

because viewers can interact with the creator in real time.

Depending on eligibility and availability in your region, TikTok LIVE can provide monetization opportunities such as virtual gifts and other platform features.

Possible LIVE formats include:

* Q&A sessions
* Gaming streams
* Tutorials
* Educational discussions
* Product demonstrations
* Entertainment
* Live challenges
* Community discussions

The most important part is having a reason for people to stay.

A LIVE session with a clear topic is generally easier to structure than simply going live without a plan.

8. Create UGC for Brands

User-generated content, or UGC, has become another opportunity for people who are good at creating short-form videos.

UGC creators make content that a company can potentially use for marketing.

You might create:

* Product demonstrations
* Unboxing videos
* Testimonials
* Tutorial videos
* Problem-and-solution clips
* Lifestyle videos
* Voiceover advertisements

One advantage of UGC is that the creator's personal following may not be the only consideration.

A company may be interested in your ability to create natural-looking, engaging content that it can use in its own marketing.

This means someone who is good at video production can potentially explore UGC even before building a massive TikTok following.

9. Use TikTok to Promote a Business

TikTok does not have to be the place where you receive the payment.

Instead, it can be the place where customers discover your business.

For example:

A restaurant can use food videos to attract local customers.

A fitness professional can publish educational clips and attract clients.

A marketing agency can demonstrate successful strategies.

An online store can showcase its products.

A local service provider can answer common customer questions.

In all these examples, TikTok acts as a marketing channel.

This is an important distinction because **making money on TikTok** does not necessarily mean getting paid by TikTok itself.

The platform can simply help you reach people who may eventually become customers.

10. Build a Personal Brand

The final method is broader but potentially useful over the long term: building a personal brand.

A personal brand gives your audience a reason to follow you beyond a single viral video.

You might become known for:

* Business advice
* Fitness
* Gaming
* Technology
* Education
* Cooking
* Travel
* Career content

* Finance education
* Productivity

Once people recognize your expertise or style, multiple monetization opportunities can develop around your audience.

These could include sponsorships, affiliate marketing, products, services, consulting, UGC, or other business opportunities.

How Do You Make Money on TikTok With a Small Account?

One of the biggest misconceptions about TikTok monetization is that you must first reach an enormous follower count.

Some methods do require specific eligibility thresholds, but not every income source depends on having a huge audience.

For example, a small account can potentially earn through:

* Affiliate sales
* Freelance services
* UGC
* Local business leads
* Digital products
* Niche sponsorships

Imagine an account with 3,000 followers focused entirely on a specific software tool.

If those followers are business owners actively looking for solutions, that audience may be commercially useful even though it is much smaller than a general entertainment

account with hundreds of thousands of followers.

Audience relevance matters.

How to Get Monetized on TikTok

If your goal is to use TikTok's own monetization features, start by checking your account's eligibility.

The exact process depends on the monetization program.

Generally, you should:

1. Keep your account in good standing.
2. Publish original content.
3. Build a consistent audience.
4. Meet any applicable follower or view requirements.
5. Check the monetization tools available in your region.
6. Review the program's current terms.
7. Apply or activate the feature when eligible.

Do not assume that one set of requirements applies to every TikTok monetization feature.

TikTok can also change eligibility rules, available programs, and regional availability over time.

How to Make Money on TikTok Videos

If you want your videos to generate income, think about the connection between the video and the monetization method.

For example:

Educational video → digital product

A creator teaches a useful skill and offers a more detailed guide.

Product tutorial → affiliate marketing

A creator demonstrates a product and provides an appropriate referral option.

Expert tips → services

A professional shares useful information and attracts potential clients.

Product demonstration → brand deal or UGC

A creator demonstrates the ability to produce marketing content.

This approach is usually more sustainable than trying to put a sales message into every video.

How Many Views Do You Need to Make Money on TikTok?

There is no universal number of views that guarantees income.

The number of views required can vary depending on the monetization method.

A video generating millions of views may not generate significant revenue if there is no suitable monetization system attached to it.

On the other hand, a video with fewer views could produce a customer, affiliate sale, or service inquiry.

For example, a highly targeted video watched by 20,000 people could potentially generate a valuable business lead.

Therefore, views are important, but they are not the only measurement that matters.

Can You Make Money on TikTok Without Showing Your Face?

Yes.

Faceless TikTok content can use formats such as:

* Screen recordings
* Voiceovers
* Tutorials
* Animations
* Product demonstrations
* Gaming footage
* Slides
* Educational graphics
* Hands-only demonstrations

The format should match the topic.

A software tutorial, for example, may work perfectly well as a screen recording with narration.

A cooking account could show the preparation process without showing the creator's face.

What matters is whether the content provides something people want to watch.

How to Make Money on TikTok Without Followers

If you have very few followers, focus on monetization methods that are not completely dependent on audience size.

UGC is one example.

Freelance services are another.

Affiliate marketing can also work when videos reach people through search and recommendations.

You can also use TikTok to generate traffic for a website or business.

This means you do not necessarily have to wait for a huge follower count before experimenting with monetization.

How Much Money Can You Make on TikTok?

There is no fixed TikTok salary.

Two creators with the same number of followers can have completely different incomes.

Revenue can depend on:

* Audience location

* Niche
* Engagement
* Video performance
* Monetization program
* Sponsorship rates
* Affiliate conversion
* Product pricing
* Service fees
* Customer value

A creator earning primarily from a service business may make more from a few clients than another creator makes from a much larger number of views.

This is why it is useful to think beyond view counts when planning a TikTok business.

TikTok Monetization in the Philippines

Creators in the Philippines may encounter different monetization options from creators in the United States, United Kingdom, or other markets.

Searches for the **Creator Rewards Program in the Philippines** are common, but availability and eligibility should be confirmed through TikTok's current information for the account and region.

Creators can also explore other methods such as:

* Affiliate marketing
* Brand partnerships
* UGC
* Services

* Digital products
* Business promotion
* LIVE features where eligible

Do not copy monetization requirements from another country without checking whether they apply to your location.

How to Choose the Right TikTok Monetization Method

Instead of trying all 10 methods simultaneously, consider your current situation.

If You Have a Small Audience

Consider:

* UGC
* Freelancing
* Affiliate marketing
* Local business leads

If You Have a Strong Niche

Consider:

* Sponsorships
* Affiliate products
* Digital products
* Services

If You Already Own a Business

Use TikTok to:

* Generate leads
* Demonstrate products
* Answer customer questions
* Build awareness
* Drive website traffic

If You Have Strong Video Skills

Consider:

* UGC
* Brand partnerships
* Sponsored content
* Video-related services

If You Have Expertise

Consider:

* Digital products
* Consulting
* Courses or educational resources
* Freelance services

The best monetization method is usually the one that fits naturally with what you already know and what your audience wants.

Tips for Making Money on TikTok in 2026

Focus on One Niche

A focused account can make it easier for viewers and potential partners to understand what you offer.

Create Strong Openings

The first few seconds of a video can determine whether someone keeps watching.

Give Viewers a Reason to Stay

Avoid unnecessary introductions. Get to the useful or entertaining part quickly.

Study Your Analytics

Look for patterns in watch time, engagement, profile visits, and content performance.

Build Trust

Do not make exaggerated income claims or recommend products you know nothing about.

Diversify Over Time

Once one monetization method works, you can gradually add another.

Keep Your Content Original

Copied content can create problems for both audience growth and monetization eligibility.

Treat TikTok as a Business Channel

If income is your goal, think about what happens after someone watches your video.

Where should that person go next?

Your profile, website, product, affiliate page, service page, or another relevant destination should have a clear purpose.

Mistakes That Can Stop TikTok Monetization Growth

Chasing Every Trend

A viral trend may generate views without attracting the audience you actually want.

Buying Followers

Artificially increasing follower numbers does not create a genuine audience and can create additional account risks.

Making False Income Claims

Claims such as "make $1,000 every day guaranteed" can damage trust and may violate platform or advertising rules.

Copying Other Creators

Use successful content as inspiration for understanding formats, but create your own ideas and presentation.

Ignoring Your Audience

If your followers came for gaming tutorials, suddenly posting unrelated financial promotions may reduce engagement.

Expecting Immediate Income

Building an audience and turning that attention into revenue generally takes time.

Frequently Asked Questions

How to make money on TikTok in 2026?
You can explore creator monetization programs, sponsorships, affiliate marketing, products, digital products, services, UGC, LIVE features, and business promotion. Availability varies by account and region.

How to make money from TikTok without spending money?
You can start with a smartphone and free creation tools. Potential methods include affiliate marketing, UGC, services, business promotion, sponsorships, and eligible TikTok monetization programs.

Can you make money on TikTok with 1,000 followers?
Potentially, yes. Some monetization methods do not require a large audience, although specific TikTok programs can have their own eligibility requirements.

How do you make money on TikTok videos?
You can connect videos with affiliate products, sponsorships, services, digital products,

UGC opportunities, business leads, or eligible creator monetization programs.

Is the TikTok Creator Fund still available?

The Creator Fund is an older TikTok monetization program. TikTok has introduced newer systems such as the Creator Rewards Program in eligible markets. Check your current TikTok account for the programs available to you.

How to get monetized on TikTok?

Review the monetization features available in your TikTok account and check the current eligibility requirements for the specific program you want to use.

Can you make money on TikTok without going viral?

Yes. Viral reach is not required for every monetization method. A smaller but relevant audience can generate affiliate sales, leads, service inquiries, UGC opportunities, or product sales.

How to make money off TikTok if you have no product?

You can explore affiliate marketing, UGC, sponsorships, freelance services, consulting, or use TikTok to generate customers for an existing business.

What is the Creator Rewards Program?

It is a TikTok creator monetization program for eligible creators in supported markets. Its eligibility and terms can vary by region and may change over time.

Final Thoughts

Learning **how to make money on TikTok** in 2026 is less about finding one secret method and more about matching your content with the right monetization model.

If you are eligible for TikTok's creator programs, you can explore those options. If you

have a skill, you can use TikTok to attract clients. If you understand a particular product category, affiliate marketing may make sense. If you can create compelling videos, UGC and brand partnerships are other possibilities.

You can also build a business around your TikTok audience through products, digital resources, services, or external websites.

Start with one clear niche, publish useful original content, learn from your analytics, and choose a monetization method that genuinely fits your audience. As your account develops, you can add additional revenue streams rather than depending on a single source of income.

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